

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Teacher Notes

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	feeling-of-knowing-forecast

Big idea: The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

Overview

Students predict which forgotten answers they would recognize later, then test the reliability of that feeling.

Student Prompt

Inspect Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

Actual Lesson Questions and Key

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how the feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Setup Checklist

- Use questions students might plausibly know but may not immediately retrieve.
- Make students forecast recognition before seeing options so the metacognitive judgement is visible.

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?
- Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron.

Suggested Timing

Stage	Teacher move	Watch for
1	Ask students to answer short recall questions without options.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
2	For unanswered items, students rate whether they would recognize the answer later.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
3	Give multiple-choice options for those same items.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
4	Students compare feeling-of-knowing forecasts with recognition accuracy.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
5	Discuss whether introspection is evidence and when it needs checking.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
Debrief	Move from the activity result to a TOK knowledge question.	Students distinguishing method, evidence, interpretation, and overclaiming.

Teacher Language

- A feeling of knowing is useful data, but it is not the same as knowing.
- What kind of evidence could confirm or challenge your feeling of familiarity?

Common Misconceptions

- Students may treat perception or memory as a recording device.
- Students may assume confidence is evidence rather than a feeling about evidence.

Assessment Look-Fors

- Separates perception, memory, belief, confidence, and justification.
- Uses the activity result to make a cautious claim about knowers.

Differentiation and Adaptations

- Support: use fewer questions and simple recognition options.
- Challenge: separate feeling-of-knowing, confidence, and source memory ratings.

Extension Tasks

- Students compare feeling-of-knowing with confidence calibration data.
- Ask students to create a revision strategy based on metacognitive evidence.

Related Activities

- Confidence Calibration Test
- False Memory Word List
- Personal Knowledge Map